INDIA IS BECOMING THE PREFERRED HEALTHCARE DESTINATION OF THE WORLD

A leader in Genitourinary care in the country, NU Hospitals has carved a niche for itself by being a focussed super specialty care chain in South India. The group with its presence now even in Maldives has plans to expand further. We caught up with **Dr. Prasanna Venkatesh M K,** the MD of NU Hospitals, Bengaluru to talk further on their plans.



DR. PRASANNA VENKATESH M K
Managing Director, Sr. Consultant Paediatric Urologist, NU Hospitals, Bengaluru

- **India is witnessing landmark changes in the healthcare sector, being a growing name in the segment, how do you see the scenario panning out?**
  Apart from providing primary and secondary health care services, India has now become a global hub to provide tertiary and quaternary care. This simply entails a lot more responsibility on all of us. NU Hospitals is a single specialty chain of hospitals that predominantly deal with the genitourinary system which is Nephrology, Urology and Fertility. This is definitely a growing space with the ageing population and associated lifestyle diseases like obesity, diabetes and hypertension. There are now more incidence of kidney related issues in India for which hospitals would really need to gear up and we are committed to grow at a faster pace to meet up this demand.
- **Please tell us about the origin and the growth story of NU Hospitals.**
  The need for such a single speciality facility was envisioned by our Chairman and Founder Dr. Venkatesh Krishnamoorthy in the year 1999 and from then on over a period of time we have grown steadily to provide more complex super specialty care in India and abroad. Our team is our biggest asset. As compared to many other hospitals, most of the doctors who work with us are here for the better part of two decades and they are all full time consultants. We are also a teaching hospital and we run post graduate courses in Urology and Nephrology from the year 2003. Our experts have gone on to establish processes across the board which helps the organisation to function more smoothly.
- **What is the general state of kidney care in India and what are your plans to make it one of the best in the world?**
  In India, Super specialty care are mainly concentrated in the top 50 cities and there is a need for it to be evenly spread out across the country. We are working on this front by focusing our expansion in tier 2 cities.

  NU Hospitals is also majorly focused on research and training. NU Hospitals was one of the first hospital in the State of Karnataka to start the Bachelor's degree and Diploma in Dialysis technology affliated with the Rajiv Gandhi University of Health Sciences. To cater to the demand for super specialists we started the DNB Nephrology and DNB Urology program which has been running successfully for the last many years. All our hospitals have the highest level of accreditation available in India, which is the NABH and NABL and we are one of the few hospitals in the country where the Ethics committees is also NABH accredited. We are proud to say that we publish anywhere between 12 to 15 articles in international journals annually.
- **You have also expanded and have gone international. Does this trend hold a better chance for Indian human resources abroad?**
  We set up the Departments of Nephrology and Urology in association with the Government of Maldives, at Male and I am happy to say that the response has been very encouraging. There is a very high demand for Nephrology and Urology in many other countries, especially in countries in the Middle East, in Southeast Asia, and many African countries. There are also very large countries which have very minimal nephrology and urology facilities. So most of those citizens would either need to travel to neighbouring countries or far off places to get the treatment. India is a favourable place for such treatments and Indian doctors are trusted the world over.
- **To conclude, what is your message to the readers and to your peers in the healthcare sector specifically?**
  I must say from my own learning that India does not only live in the urban areas alone and there is a huge population in the rural areas which do not have access to complex care. So for the next few years we are going to see a lot of development in the tier 2 towns and we all must be part of this change. Yes, there are challenges of getting trained and skilled manpower there, but it is just a question of time. We must work together to provide a more specialised and equitable healthcare facility across our country.

  I would like to conclude by saying that India over the next decade or two is going to see significant strides in healthcare. We are going to do a lot more complex specialty work and we are already at par with whatever is happening in the western world. So good and exciting times are ahead for us in the realm of healthcare.